BCM Tool

Shared PPT by customer:

Business_Continuity_AI_Tool_v2.pptx

Meeting Transcript:

https://copilot.clari.com/guest/sharedCall/69a907c03430d207aacf12f5

One-Sentence Summary

KAUST is exploring an **AI-powered Business Continuity platform** that can analyze operational documentation, identify vulnerabilities, generate crisis scenarios, design and run emergency exercises, evaluate response effectiveness, and automatically maintain **Business Impact Analysis (BIA)** and **Business Continuity Plans (BCP)**.

What the Customer Is Asking

KAUST currently manages **Business Continuity Management (BCM)** largely through manual processes.

These activities include reviewing documents to identify operational risks, running workshops to design emergency exercises, conducting one-hour BIA interviews with each department, and manually drafting and updating Business Continuity Plans.

With **200+ labs, departments, and operational units**, maintaining continuity planning in this way is time-consuming and difficult to keep current.

The customer is exploring whether an **AI-driven system** could act as a digital BCM analyst that supports multiple stages of the continuity lifecycle.

Specifically, they are interested in a platform capable of:

- analyzing internal documentation to identify operational vulnerabilities
- converting those vulnerabilities into **realistic disruption scenarios**
- automatically designing **tabletop simulations and emergency exercises**
- dynamically adapting scenarios based on participant responses during exercises
- generating **after-action reports and improvement recommendations**
- conducting **conversational BIA interviews** with departments
- automatically generating and updating **Business Continuity Plans**
- providing a **secure internal assistant** for BCM best practices and document analysis

The overall objective is to **reduce manual effort, improve visibility into operational risks, and maintain audit-ready continuity planning across the organization.**

Overall System Flow

At a high level, the system would operate as a pipeline that converts internal documentation and operational knowledge into structured continuity insights and plans.

```
Enterprise Documents / SharePoint
           ↓
Vulnerability Discovery
           ↓
Scenario Generation
           ↓
Exercise Design
           ↓
```

```
Adaptive Simulation
            ↓
After-Action Reporting
            ↓
Business Impact Analysis (BIA)
            ↓
Business Continuity Plan (BCP)
```

Conceptually, this lifecycle could be implemented through **a set of AI agents or services**, each responsible for a stage of the BCM workflow.

Inputs

The platform would primarily rely on **internal enterprise documentation**.

Key sources include:

Internal knowledge

- existing business continuity plans
- IT disaster recovery documentation
- utilities and infrastructure strategies
- departmental SOPs
- risk registers
- historical BIA and BCP documents

Enterprise systems

- SharePoint repositories
- internal document storage systems

Optional external data (future phase)

- regional risk intelligence
- environmental and climate risks
- BCM industry frameworks and standards

User interaction

Users would interact with the platform through a **chat-style interface and structured forms**, for example:

- querying documents
- configuring exercises
- entering participant decisions during simulations
- completing conversational BIA interviews

Outputs

The system would generate both **operational insights** and **governance outputs**.

Operational Outputs

- identified operational vulnerabilities
- dependency maps between systems and departments
- realistic disruption scenarios
- exercise plans and simulation scripts
- dynamic scenario injects during drills
- after-action reports and improvement recommendations

Governance Outputs

- updated risk insights for BCM programs
- **audit-ready evidence aligned with ISO 22301**
- executive dashboards summarizing continuity posture
- structured BIA datasets
- automatically generated or updated BCP documents

Core AI Capabilities

1. Document Intelligence

The platform analyzes internal documentation to identify **single points of failure, operational dependencies, and continuity risks**.

This provides the foundational knowledge required to generate meaningful crisis scenarios.

2. Scenario Generation

Based on discovered vulnerabilities, the system can generate **realistic disruption scenarios** by modeling potential causes, escalation paths, and operational impacts.

These scenarios form the basis for exercises and resilience testing.

3. Exercise Design

The system can automatically create **structured emergency exercises**, including:

- exercise objectives
- scenario timelines
- participant roles
- evaluation metrics
- facilitator guidance

This significantly reduces the manual effort required to design continuity drills.

4. Adaptive Simulation Engine

During an exercise, facilitators can input participant decisions into the system.

The platform then evaluates those responses and **generates new scenario developments dynamically**, allowing simulations to evolve realistically.

This capability is particularly valuable for revealing hidden capability gaps that static exercises often miss.

5. After-Action Intelligence

Following a simulation, the platform automatically generates structured reports including:

- performance evaluation
- root cause analysis
- identified capability gaps
- recommended improvement actions

These outputs can directly support governance processes and internal audits.

6. Conversational BIA Assistant

Instead of manual interviews, departments can interact with a conversational AI that guides them through the **Business Impact Analysis process**.

The system captures structured information such as:

- critical business processes
- acceptable downtime (RTO)
- operational dependencies
- financial and operational impacts

This information is stored as structured BIA data.

7. Automated BCP Generation

Using the captured BIA data, the system can automatically generate or update **Business Continuity Plans** by populating predefined templates and identifying missing information.

This removes much of the manual effort currently required to maintain BCP documentation.

Additional Capabilities

BCM Knowledge Assistant

Users can interact with the platform through a **secure internal AI assistant** to:

- ask BCM best-practice questions
- analyze documents
- explore risk scenarios
- retrieve relevant policies or procedures

Executive Dashboard

Leadership also expressed interest in a **dashboard view of organizational continuity posture**, similar to a PowerBI interface.

This could provide visibility into:

- BIA completion across departments
- BCP coverage
- critical operational systems
- vulnerability hotspots
- exercise performance results
- outstanding remediation actions

Key Implementation Considerations

While most capabilities are technically feasible with current AI architectures, several areas may require careful design.

Enterprise knowledge integration

The platform will depend heavily on internal documentation stored in SharePoint and related repositories. Reliable ingestion, indexing, and contextual retrieval will be critical for accurate analysis.

Adaptive simulation logic

The dynamic exercise engine introduces additional complexity beyond standard document analysis systems. It may require structured decision frameworks to guide scenario evolution.

Structured data modeling (BIA → BCP)

Automating the transition from conversational BIA interviews to structured datasets and BCP documents requires clear schema design and template mapping.

What Was Discussed During the Meeting

During the discussion, several clarifications were provided by the KAUST team:

- **SharePoint will be the primary data source** initially
- external intelligence sources may be added in later phases
- the interface should be **chat-based, similar to ChatGPT**
- facilitators will likely **enter participant responses manually during simulations**
- BIA and BCP outputs will rely on **existing organizational templates**
- KAUST is open to **AI-generated improvements to those templates**
- an **executive dashboard summarizing BCM posture** is expected
- the system should also support **general BCM consulting-style queries** beyond specific workflows

The **next step requested by the customer** is a **technical feasibility assessment and a financial proposal** for building the platform.